

Combat Sports Strength & Conditioning Program

IG - @Peteyurr

An 8 week program carefully constructed for combat athletes to develop strength, power, and cardiovascular adaptation. Get more growth out of less volume to ensure you're always fresh for your sport. 3 strength days, well rounded conditioning, and optional mobility work.

Introduction:

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WHAT THIS PROGRAM DOES:

Get you to start thinking about how to train smarter in the gym so that your strength and conditioning COMPLEMENT your sport, instead of subtracting from it. I made the big mistake of thinking I could still slam 10 different arm exercises in a day without being too gassed for martial arts class.

But after applying what I've learned as an Exercise Scientist on load management and building smarter programs, I've gotten stronger, faster, and can go round after round in the gym without thinking. I truly believe physical fitness should never be a limiting factor in combat sports.

It sucks not being able to perform a technique because you don't have the energy for it, or aren't powerful enough to complete it fast enough. So that's why I created a program that me, others from my gym, and clients have found to be extremely successful in giving them freedom they've never seen with their sport.

Weekly Framework:

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Power Lift Days:

- Monday (Strength A)
- Wednesday (Strength B)
- Friday (Strength C + Conditioning)

Additional conditioning:

- Assault bike: 1x/week (Short Bursts)
- Running: 2x/week (Mostly Zone 2)
- Plyometrics built into lifting days

Mobility / Isometric Work

Built into warm ups + Sunday optional focused longer session

At the end of this program I have templates for you to track progress. I highly encourage you to print them out or copy into your notes app to keep yourself accountable from week to week.

Gauging “Pain”

Think of pain as a tool to understand your body’s language.

All exercise is a type of “pain” because you’re putting your body through demands it may have not yet encountered. You likely have learned how to manage pain well as a combat sports athlete. But knowing when you’re putting in too much fatigue is also extremely important so you’re not an overtrained athlete. A plan you can recover from is a plan you will stick to.

Just note this general guideline to follow when pain shows up in a workout.

Stoplight Tool:

GREEN:

Burning sensation, fatigue. Challenging but safe. Normal during sets. Keep going. (0-3/10)

YELLOW:

Aching, stiff, uncomfortable. Often joint or tendons.

Should improve as you warm-up and continue. Slow down, lighten load, or move on if worsens. (4-6/10)

RED:

Sharp, Stabbing, sudden pain. Feels unstable or unsafe. Stop/modify. (7-10/10)

[Watch this or ask Jake for more detail](#)

Warm up:

(Before every strength day)

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Click [here](#) for quick demo:

- 90/90 Hip Flow / Hip CARS 60-90s
- Worlds Greatest Stretch Flow, each side 30s
- Split Squats, 5 reps each side, then 5 reps jumping
 - Prone Shoulder CARS, 10 slow

***Click on each exercise name in the program for a link to access exercise demonstrations**

Day 1

Strength Day A

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Weight, % 1 RM or RPE
Scapular push-ups (On Elbows).	2	8	BW
Push-Press	3	4-8	70-80% 1RM
Smith Machine Squat (Quad Focus).	2	8-12	70-85% 1RM
Seated Cable Row (Wide grip , pull to upper pecs).	3	6-8	80-85% 1RM
Cable Tricep Extension	3	8-10	70-85% 1RM

Day 3

Strength Day B

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Weight, % 1 RM or RPE
Single Leg Bounds	3	5 (each leg)	BW
Scapular Pull Ups	1	5	BW
Pull Ups	3	5-10	BW
Bench Press	3	3-8	75-85% 1RM
Bulgarian Split Squat's	3	6-8	70-85% 1RM
Chest Fly (Any Variation)	2	10-12	60-75% 1RM

+ Optional Zone 2 Run (20-30m easy pace)

Day 4

Conditioning + Plyometrics

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Weight, % 1 RM or RPE
Skater Jumps	2	10 (each direction)	BW
Assault Bike Intervals	8	15s on, 45s off	7-8 RPE on, 2-3 RPE off

Day 5

Strength Day C

Exercise	Sets	Reps	Weight, % 1 RM or RPE
Max Intent Depth Jumps	2	5	BW
Walking DB Lunges	3	15-20 Steps/Side	70-85% 1RM
Incline DB Press	3	5-8	70-85% 1RM
Vertical Lat Pulldown Machine	2	5-8	70-85% 1RM
Quad Extension Machine	2	6-8	70-85% 1RM

Day 7

Recovery / Mobility (Optional)

<u>Cossack Squats</u>	10 reps	2 sets
<u>Pike elevated leg raises</u>	10 reps	2 sets
<u>Frog Stance, Pelvic tilts</u>	15 reps	1 set
<u>ER / IR Isometric Holds</u>	5 reps (hold contraction for 5 seconds each rep)	2 sets
<u>Dead hang from bar</u>	(Drop once hands start to slip – push close to failure)	2 sets
Neck <u>Flexion</u> and <u>Extension</u>	10 reps	2 (each)

Focused hip hobility, shoulder health, and neck health to protect and enable the joints and surrounding tissue that endure the most stress in sport!

Operational definitions:

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RPE:

“Rate of Perceived Exertion”: How does the intensity of exercise feel to you? Scale of 1-10.

(Moderate intensity: 3-5)

(Vigorous Intensity: 6-8)

RIR = “Reps in Reserve”:

The reps left in your “tank” before you can’t complete another clean rep
– absolute mechanical failure.

Make a note on tracking template next to # of reps completed how many RIR you had left.

“SET 1: 8 reps, 3 RIR”

Run:

Up a pace from Jogging. RPE = 5-6

Jog:

Zone 2 cardio or easy enough of a pace to hold a conversation.

RPE = 3-4

**Tip: Accelerate and decelerate paces gradually during workouts.

Ex. Decelerate into a run, a jog, and finally a walking pace.

How to use Tracking Templates:

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Take careful note of your weight, reps, sets, and how each exercise felt to you. Do this for each workout and each week to map progress. When you get good at judging effort, you can use RPE scale of 1-10 in the “How’d it feel” box.

You can also note how many reps you could’ve gotten if you put MAXIMUM effort into the set. (Ex. under “Set 1”: “8 reps, 3 R.I.R.” for “Reps in Reserve”)

If that’s too confusing, just write the rep number you lifted under “Set 1,2,3,...”

and under “How’d it feel” box, just write either “easy/medium/hard”).

For conditioning, just write the exercise modality (“assault bike”), duration (15s on/45s off), and number of rounds (how many sets). Then note intensity using RPE or easy/medium/hard.

These principles take time to understand and use, so if they are confusing to you, I have video’s linked above in the “Operational Definitions” page. It’s VERY worth your time to get good at judging intensity and tracking it now so learn how to not overtrain, and can look back from week to week to modify and progress exercises and loads.

I welcome you to reach out to me Via instagram @Peteyurr or by email - jake24peterson@gmail.com if you would like guidance applying these programming principles.

4 Week Progression

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Recycle 2x,

Use Week 3 lift numbers as baseline for week 5 (5% heavier) ,
then progress everything else accordingly.

Week 6: 1-2 lifts should increase by 5-10lbs (Clean/Press, Bench, RDL)

Week 1:	- Find Reps, track RPE/RIR - Keep conditioning the same	Establish Load: Baseline, Movement Quality
Week 2:	- Lifts: Increase 1 set for compounds - Conditioning: +5 minutes to zone 2 runs, keep ECHO bike the same	Slight Volume Increase
Week 3:	- Lifts: Increase to 80-85% 1RM for compounds, +5-10lbs) - Conditioning: +2 ECHO bike rounds , everything else the same	Peak Week: Increase weight, focus on explosiveness
Week 4:	- Lifts: Reduce volume by 40-50%, reduce load 10-20% - Conditioning: No hard sparring, slightly reduce assault bike rounds - Mobility: Spend longer on ISO's and Mobility work (DAY 7)	Deload Week: Recovery/Joint Health Focus

FAQ's

WHO IS THIS FOR? @Peteyurr

Combat athletes training their sport
multiple days per week.

IS THIS INDIVIDUALIZED?

No. This is a general performance
framework, not 1-on-1 coaching. *****LINK!!!!

IS THIS A FIGHT CAMP PLAN?

No. It supports fight training but does
not replace camp-specific conditioning.

HOW IS CONDITIONING SET UP?

- 1 dedicated conditioning day
- 2 flexible Zone 2 aerobic sessions
- Plyometrics built into strength work

HOW HARD SHOULD LIFTS FEEL?

Challenging but clean.
Use RPE/RIR. Avoid grinding or failure.

WHAT IF A LIFT FEELS OFF?

Modify it. Reduce load, adjust range,
or swap movements.

CUTTING WEIGHT?

This program does not adjust for
caloric restriction or weight cuts.

WHEN DO I NEED COACHING?

Fight prep, injuries, stalled progress,
or sport-specific conditioning.

FINAL NOTE

This program is a foundation.
Coaching = customization.

Email: jake24peterson@gmail.com for individualized guidance.

Weekly Tracking

Date: Week #____ Workout day #____

Exercise	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Weight	How'd it feel?

Other notes:

Sleep:

Recovery &
Mood/Energy:

Joints:

Nutrition Today:

Weekly Tracking

Date: Week #____ Workout day #____

Exercise	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Weight	How'd it feel?

Other notes:

Sleep:

Recovery &
Mood/Energy:

Joints:

Nutrition Today:

Weekly Tracking:

Combat Sports Skill development:

What skill do I want to focus on developing this week?

Use this note sheet to keep track of what your learning in class, what you want to focus on, current strengths/weaknesses and anything notable from your training. Even if its just shadowboxing or drilling practice that day make a note of it.

Monday Notes:

Tuesday Notes:

Wednesday Notes:

Thursday Notes:

Friday Notes:

Saturday Notes:

Sunday Notes: